

Matt Everitt

DESIGN OPERATIONS MANAGER

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PROFILE

Design system product owner with six years at Ideagen, from founding the system as a junior designer to running it for a portfolio of 60+ products. Owns the strategy, roadmap, backlog, releases and adoption of a versioned specification that AI coding agents build from, with an automated gate that rejects anything that breaks it. Strong on hypothesis testing, prioritisation, product metrics and accessibility, and on getting teams to adopt new ways of working.

EXPERIENCE

Design Operations Manager
AUG 2022 – PRESENT
Ideagen

- Led a front-end engineer and a UI designer on the design system until February 2026, setting priorities and allocating resource. Sole product owner since.
- Retired the 45-component library I built for a written specification (tokens, component rules, definition of done) that AI coding agents build from. Judged three options on five criteria and re-presented the roadmap at CTO level.
- Tested the bet in stages. 9 products are piloting it and 6 are in production on a pinned release, including the AI agent and home hub.
- Set a north star of products in production, with a guardrail on how fast critical fixes reach adopters. Time to first gate pass fell from 9 days to under 1, and screens take a median 1.5 days against 5.
- Built a CI gate with Claude Code that has blocked 117 accessibility failures before merge since July 2026, with a 71% first-run pass rate over 186 builds.
- Shipped 95 tagged releases since July 2026, with semantic versioning, changelogs and a decision log of 170+ entries. Turned the first team requests into released contracts within two weeks.
- Built WCAG 2.2 AA into the tokens so failing pairs block a release, and designed an AI disclosure component for EU AI Act Article 50.
- Own the asset pack, with 47 entries from 7 contributing designers, and wrote the adoption guide and one-command setup.
- Run a 15-agent Claude Code harness that reproduces, tests and verifies every change, and mentor teams adopting AI-assisted workflows.

UX/UI Designer
JUN 2021 – AUG 2022
Ideagen

- Designed and documented the company's first design system and its component library, 45 components built in React, Vue and Angular.
- Managed design requests from many teams, balancing priorities, and worked with developers through handoff and implementation.
- Tracked design system performance through feedback and user experience metrics.

Junior UI Designer
MAR 2020 – JUN 2021
Ideagen

- Started the company design system, contributing to long-term product strategy.
- Completed 10 UX courses alongside the role and applied them to the design system and its workflows.

PORTFOLIO

matteveritt.co.uk
Case study and three short reads on the spec AI builds from

EDUCATION

BA (Hons) Graphic Design
Sheffield Hallam University
2016 – 2019

UX Design Certificates (10x)
Interaction Design Foundation
2020 – 2021

CORE

Product ownership
Design system strategy
Roadmapping
Prioritisation
Release management
Accessibility WCAG 2.2 AA
AI-assisted development

SKILLS

Hypothesis testing
Product metrics
Backlog management
Stakeholder management
Governance
Design tokens
Component contracts
CI checks
Claude Code
Resource management
Agile
Cross-functional collaboration
Figma
Adobe Creative Suite